

IDAHO STATE PLAN RENEWAL for TEMPORARY ASSISTANCE FOR NEEDY FAMILIES (TANF)

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE
PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY AND WORK
OPPORTUNITY RECONCILIATION ACT OF 1996 (P. L. 104-193)

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1. INTRODUCTION

Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) is the federal program that replaced the Aid to Families with Dependent Children (AFDC) program under federal welfare reform legislation, the Personal Responsibility and Work Opportunity Reconciliation Act of 1996 (PRWORA), P. L. 104-193. The program is supervised by the State of Idaho, through the Department of Health and Welfare (Department).

The TANF block grant is used to provide cash assistance, services, and work programs for needy families, utilizing federal TANF funds along with state funds to develop and deliver services to needy families. Idaho operates its TANF program in accordance with this plan; Idaho Statute Title 56, Public Assistance and Welfare, Chapter 2, Public Assistance; and Idaho Administrative Rules.

This plan was approved and in effect as of September 30, 1995. The State of Idaho (the State) will amend its TANF State Plan whenever the Department determines there is a significant change in program policy or rule. In the event of changes to Idaho's TANF program, the rules are published in the Administrative Rules Bulletin with legal notices regarding the changes published in Idaho's major daily newspapers. The public has 12 days to comment on rule changes. This document, Idaho's TANF State Plan, was posted on the Department's web site October 23, 2025 at <http://www.healthandwelfare.idaho.gov>. Notice of this posting and the opportunity to comment (October 23– December 7, 2025) were published in Idaho's major daily newspapers October 23, 24, 25, and 28, 2025. This provided the mandatory 45-day period for public review and comment.

A. Administration

Idaho employs a service area structure working in concert with a centralized business office to ensure effective delivery of the program. Appendix A is a chart of the Department's structure. Service delivery is provided at the local level by Department employees and contracted staff.

B. Department Mission and Program Goals

The Department's mission is to create and support an environment that encourages family responsibility and self-reliance while promoting and protecting the health and safety of Idahoans. The overriding goal of Idaho's TANF program is to help Idaho's needy families achieve self-sufficiency by providing them access to job preparation, work, and support services.

C. Program Purposes and Use of Funds

The purpose of the TANF program is to help participants secure employment by offering support and assistance. Achieving this goal requires collaboration beyond what the government alone can provide. Success depends on strong partnerships between participants, their families, local communities, and employers working together to promote employment and self-reliance.

Department resources for applicants and participants will be provided in the following priority order, when applicable: Child Support Services (CSS); child care assistance; other Department services such as Medicaid, Food Stamps, Aid to the Aged, Blind, and Disabled (AABD); and finally, TANF.

Idaho uses TANF funds to accomplish the following purposes established by P.L. 104-193 (42 U.S.C. 601(a)(1)):

- Provide assistance to needy families so that children may be cared for in their own homes or in the homes of relatives.

- End the dependence of needy parents on government benefits by promoting job preparation, work, and marriage.
- Prevent and reduce the incidence of out-of-wedlock pregnancies and establish annual numerical goals for preventing and reducing the incidence of these pregnancies; and
- Encourage the formation and maintenance of two-parent families.

The State will adhere to the 15% administrative cost limitation as specified in 45 CFR 263.13. The State will account for TANF administrative costs using the final rule for TANF (45 CFR Part 263).

D. TANF Eligibility Requirements

i. Financial Eligibility

Unless otherwise noted, the income limit for TANF eligibility is 200% of the federal poverty guideline and the resource limit is \$5,000. For eligible families with earned income, a final TANF amount is calculated by subtracting sixty percent (60%) of gross earned income, one hundred percent (100%) of any unearned income, and any applicable penalties from the Work Incentive Table based on the family size. The grant amount is the result of this calculation rounded to the next lowest dollar or the maximum grant, whichever is less. There is a forty percent (40%) income disregard for all earned income and no disregard for unearned income.

ii. Citizenship

The electronic interface SAVE, is used to verify citizenship of applicants. If a discrepancy exists between the SAVE interface and the applicant's statement, then the applicant must provide documentation that they are citizens or lawful permanent residents of the United States. Acceptable documentation includes birth certificate, passport, or documentation from the US Department of Homeland Security.

iii. Non-Citizens

All qualified aliens who reside in the United States have access to cash assistance if they are eligible, unless otherwise limited by Federal law. TANF assistance is provided to all accepted categories as required by Title IV of PRWORA and to all non-accepted categories after the expiration of the 5-year bar. Idaho does not provide a State-funded assistance program for individuals who are barred for their first five years. The 5-year bar does not apply to aliens who entered the United States before August 22, 1996.

iv. Trafficking Victims

Pursuant to Public Law 106-386 and the Victims of Trafficking and Violence Protection Act of 2000, victims of a severe form of trafficking shall be eligible for benefits. This eligibility is without regard to actual immigration status of such victims. Victims of trafficking, like refugees, are not barred from receiving TANF during their first five years.

v. Idaho State Residence

Idaho residency is verified via the customer's self-declaration, unless questionable. When Idaho residency is questionable, then the applicant must present documentation to prove they are residents of the State of Idaho and must include the customer's name and Idaho address.

2. TANF PROGRAMS AND SERVICES

Idaho's TANF funds provide cash assistance to needy families in Idaho TANF funds also support an array of other programs and services to eligible families and individuals who meet the eligibility criteria established by the four TANF purposes and rules of the Department of Health and Welfare in accordance with this State plan.

A. Temporary Cash Assistance for Families in Idaho (TANF)

Idaho provides TANF cash payments to needy families with children, including two-parent households. Idaho families with a dependent child, or pregnant women in the third trimester of pregnancy, meet the definition of "needy" if their countable household earned income (after the 40% earned income disregard) and unearned income is below 32% of the 200% federal poverty level for the budget unit size. A family is considered "needy" when their countable monthly income (earned and unearned) is less than \$309, the maximum grant amount. The family resource limit for TANF is \$5,000. TANF applicants must comply with all program requirements to receive benefits.

Each individual applying for cash assistance must state in writing whether the individual or any member of their household has been convicted of a felony involving a controlled substance. However, Idaho has exercised the opt-out provision in section 115 of PRWORA, P.L. 104-193. Accordingly, the Department may provide Food Stamps and services funded under Title IV-A (including cash assistance, TANF supportive services and at-risk services) to a person who has been convicted of a felony involving a controlled substance, if they comply with the terms of a withheld judgment, probation or parole.

B. Benefit Delivery

Delivery of cash benefits is made through electronic benefit transfers (EBT), either directly to a recipient's bank account or to an account maintained by the State on behalf of the recipient through an electronic benefits transfer (EBT) vendor. The EBT system is an online system accessed with plastic magnetic strip cards and personal identification numbers (PINs). Benefits are accessible through point of sale (POS) devices at participating retailers or at automated teller machines (ATMs). The EBT system is operable anywhere in the United States where the retailer or ATM displays the Quest logo. The Quest logo signifies that the retailer or ATM owner follows the national operating rules for EBT adopted by the National Automated Clearing House Association (NACHA).

During the 2012 Legislative Session, the Idaho State Legislature passed a law addressing the Prohibited Uses of Public Assistance Benefit Cards; more specifically, this law addressed the use of TANF benefits provided to a recipient on an Idaho Quest EBT card account (Section 56-227F, Idaho Code, Effective 07/01/2012). The enacted Statute outlines that:

- TANF recipients cannot use their EBT card for restricted activities such as gambling; purchase of cigarettes, tobacco, or alcohol; adult entertainment; tattoos; or activities in any restricted location as outlined in the legislation; and
- Certain types of businesses are restricted from accepting TANF EBT benefits, specifically: businesses that sell alcoholic beverages by the drink; state liquor stores; gambling establishments; businesses offering tattoo or body modification services; adult entertainment venues; and any establishment where persons under age 18 are not permitted.

For a machine to process an Idaho Quest EBT card transaction, the machine must belong to a vendor approved by the State and have a specified BIN number. The Department of Health and Welfare maintains a list of approved EBT vendors and BIN numbers throughout the state. No casinos, gaming establishments, liquor stores, or adult entertainment venues are approved vendors for Idaho Quest EBT card transactions.

TANF recipients are informed of the EBT card prohibited vendor types and prohibited items both at the time of application and when then recipient requests to receive their cash benefit on an EBT card. This information is also posted in our offices and is available on the Idaho Department of Health and Welfare website. TANF recipients are also given an informational brochure entitled “A Guide for Using your Idaho Quest Card.” This brochure informs recipients:

- Which types of transactions involve no fees or charges;
- Which types of transactions involve fees and/or surcharges; and
- Where they can access or withdraw their cash benefits (POS terminals at retail locations statewide, ATM machines, online bill pay).

This informational brochure is made publicly available on the Idaho Department of Health and Welfare website and is given to individuals who receive a Quest card in the local offices.

C. Child-only TANF Grants

TANF is available to eligible children who reside with a caretaker relative. A caretaker relative is an adult relative, other than a parent who has an eligible child residing with them and is responsible for the child’s care. For child-only grants, a family member includes individuals related by immediate family (such as siblings or stepparent) or extended family (including grandparents, uncles, aunts, cousins) connections. These relationships may be established through marriage, and even if the marriage ends, the State continues to recognize the familial relationship for TANF eligibility purposes.

Caretaker relatives have the option to be included or excluded from the TANF grant.

For child-only cases:

- Only the child’s income is considered when determining eligibility.
- TANF time limits do not apply to caretaker relatives.
- Caretaker relatives who are not included in the grant are exempt from TANF work activity requirements.
- However, all caretaker relatives included in the TANF grant must meet participation requirements for work activities.
- Caretaker relatives not included in the grant are encouraged but not required to cooperate with Child Support Services (CSS) by completing referral forms.
- Caretaker relatives included in the grant are required to cooperate with CSS to identify and locate the non-custodial parent, establish paternity, and establish, modify and enforce the child support order, unless good cause exists.

D. Participation in Work Activities

Idaho uses a statewide contractor to manage and deliver Employment and Training (E&T) services for participants in the TANF program. This contractor is responsible for the development and coordination

of work opportunity sites, individualized employment services and the provision of work activity hours to the Department. These hours are used to determine the State's work participation rate to ensure compliance with Section 407(a)(1) of the Social Security Act.

All TANF applicants are referred to the E&T contractor for assessment and participation in mandatory work activities. The specific activities assigned are based on each participant's circumstances and may require up to forty (40) hours per week participation in work-related activities, as defined in the Work-Related Activities section. Work activities may include but are not limited to:

- Paid employment, including self-employment earning at least the federal minimum wage
- Unpaid work or community service
- Work search and job readiness activities
- Education aimed at obtaining a high school diploma or equivalency
- Work preparation or vocational education
- Job skills training
- Other activities that enhance a participant's ability to achieve employment and self-reliance

A single parent of a child who is less than six (6) years of age is not required to participate in work activities if one or more of the following child care related barriers are present. These barriers may be identified during the initial eligibility determination or during the development of the participant's work plan with the E&T contractor:

Appropriate Child Care Not Available: Appropriate care includes licensed providers or license exempt providers as outlined in IDAPA, or client preferred informal child care (e.g. family, friends, or neighbors) with operating hours that align with the participant's work schedule.

Reasonable Distance: Appropriate child care is not available within a responsible distance from the participant's home or assigned work site. "Reasonable distance" is defined as a total travel time of no more than one (1) hour via public or private transportation.

Relative or Informal Child Care: Informal child care provided by relatives or others is either unavailable or unsuitable. Unsuitability is determined on a case-by case basis, and may include concerns related to safety, stability, or adequacy of care and supervision.

Affordable: Child care is considered unaffordable if, after applying subsidies and any provider discounts, the participant's out of pocket child care expenses, exceed 50% of their cash benefits.

Participation of Other Household Members: All adult mandatory household members must engage in work activities for up to forty (40) hours per week. In addition, any child between the ages of sixteen (16) and eighteen (18) who is not attending school is also required to participate in assigned work activities up to forty (40) hours per week.

Community Collaboration and Resource Maximization: The E&T contractor works in partnership with community organizations and local resources to maximize available services and prevent duplication. This collaborative approach ensures that participants receive comprehensive, coordinated support tailored to their individual needs, increasing the likelihood of successful employment and long-term self-sufficiency.

E. One-Time TANF Cash Payment

Idaho offers one-time cash payments as an alternative TANF payment method. A one-time TANF cash payment can be received only once in a lifetime. To be eligible for a one-time cash payment, families must meet all general eligibility requirements. The family must have a need that cannot be met with existing resources. The one-time cash payment may be up to three times the maximum TANF grant the family would have been eligible to receive. Each month used by the one-time payment counts as two months against the 24-month lifetime TANF limit. Eligibility for one-time cash payments is based on needs such as car repair, moving expenses, employment agency fee, tools, uniforms, and housing expenses. A family already receiving TANF can apply for a one-time cash payment to use for employment related expenses such as relocation and moving expenses, work uniforms, and tools necessary to accept or retain employment.

F. Time Limit

TANF is designed to provide temporary cash assistance while fostering personal and family responsibility, work, and self-reliance. Monthly cash benefits are provided to eligible families up to a lifetime limit of 24 months. Eligible families moving to Idaho from another state are entitled to TANF cash benefits up to the 24-month time limit. Cash assistance benefits received from another state after July 1, 1997, count against Idaho's 24-month lifetime limit.

Cash assistance provided for relative caretaker child-only cases, with no adult included in the grant, is not time-limited.

Cash assistance provided for child-only cases with an eligible dependent child/ren and an ineligible non-citizen parent on the case are subject to the 24-month time limit.

G. Extended Cash Assistance

Extended Cash Assistance (ECA) may be provided to families who have received 24 months of assistance. All TANF eligibility criteria apply to ECA. In addition to all the eligibility requirements for TANF, all adults in the family must meet one (1) of the following conditions:

- A mental or physical condition expected to last at least three months. The condition must prevent any employment that would generate earnings of at least one hundred sixty-seven percent (167%) of the maximum grant per month.
- Providing care for an ill or incapacitated child or spouse in the home. The in-home care must be provided for a minimum of one month. The care must prevent any employment that would generate earnings of at least one hundred sixty-seven percent (167%) of the maximum grant per month.

Time Limit: ECA may be paid for an additional 36 months after the 24-month temporary cash assistance time limit, but all adults in the family must continue to meet both ECA and temporary cash assistance eligibility criteria.

H. Individual Responsibility Plan

Families who apply for and receive TANF work with the Department to develop an Individual Responsibility Plan (IRP). This negotiated plan clearly outlines the steps the family intends to take to achieve self-reliance, identifies the expectations a family must meet to continue receiving TANF, and identifies the resources available through the Department to support the participant's self-reliance plan.

Idaho's program requires all mandatory adult members of the family to participate in work activities up to 40 hours per week. As part of the IRP, both initial and continued cooperation with Child Support Services is mandated. The IRP also identifies the steps the Department must take. The Department will ensure that basic services are adequate to help the family fulfill the terms of the IRP. Food Stamps, Medicaid, child care, and other resources available in the community are discussed with the family. Families may apply for these services during this initial contact or whenever needed. During initial contact with the Department, families are encouraged to identify and use their own personal resources or resources within the community. Department personnel assist families as needed, emphasizing steps the family can use to access alternative resources.

I. Drug and Alcohol Screening

As part of the TANF eligibility determination, adult applicants are screened for alcohol and substance abuse using the Substance Abuse Subtle Screening Inventory (SASSI), in compliance with Idaho law. This screening helps identify substance abuse barriers that can impair an individual's ability to obtain and maintain employment.

When screening results indicate a reasonable suspicion that a participant is engaged in or at high risk of substance abuse, the Department will refer the individual to a department-approved substance abuse contractor for a comprehensive assessment. Based on the assessment, a trained drug and alcohol professional will provide treatment recommendations. These recommendations are then incorporated into the participant's Individual Responsibility Plan (IRP) as required work activities. Early identification and intervention support families in accessing treatment and reducing long-term welfare dependency.

J. Unmarried Minor Parents

Unmarried minor parents must reside with the parents of either of the minor parties included in the TANF grant in order to receive TANF, unless they have good cause to live separately.

K. Privacy Protection

In compliance with the Health Information Privacy and Portability Act, the Department has taken necessary steps to restrict the use and disclosure of information about individuals and families receiving assistance under programs funded by the federal government. The Department may share information about participants with county welfare programs to avoid inaccurate or duplicated benefits.

L. Fair Hearings

Administrative appeals and contested cases are governed by the provisions of IDAPA 16.05.03, "Contested Case Proceedings and Declaratory Rulings." Unless exempted, all public records are subject to disclosure by the Department that will comply with Title 74, Chapter 1, Idaho Code, upon requests. Confidential information may be restricted by state or federal law, federal regulation, and IDAPA 16.05.01, "Use and Disclosure of Department Records."

A family may request a fair hearing to contest a department decision up to thirty (30) days after the date a notice was mailed to them. The family may continue to receive assistance during the hearing process if the Department receives the request for continued benefits within ten (10) days from the date the notice was mailed. Assistance will continue at the current month's level while the hearing decision is pending, unless the 24-month limit is reached or another change affecting the family's eligibility occurs.

M. TANF Cash Assistance for Victims of Catastrophe

In the event of an officially declared catastrophe, the State employs a Continuity of Operations Plan (COOP) that ensures essential services, such as providing cash assistance, continues during an emergency.

N. Services and Activities Available to Participants Receiving TANF

The Department uses the full range of activities allowed in the federal law (Personal Responsibility and Work Opportunity Reconciliation Act of 1996) to reinforce personal and family responsibility and further the family's self-reliance goals. Each family's IRP identifies and requires participation in activities that meet the standards of participation defined in the law. Additional activities not defined in federal law, such as classes and programs in parenting, budgeting, decision-making, problem solving, conflict resolution, health, and hygiene, are identified and added to the family's IRP.

Examples of additional services and resources are listed below:

- *Community Service*: Community service activities may be included in the IRP. Community service is not mandated in deference to other activities that may better prepare a family to become stable.
- *Employment Services*: The Department works with communities to identify employment opportunities for TANF participants. Unpaid opportunities are developed for work experience sites wherever necessary. These sites teach basic job skills to provide participants with current employment references and the basic skills needed to obtain employment. Participants are encouraged to be involved in other community activities to expand employment options.
- *Transportation Services*: Transportation is available to those who could not otherwise participate in the activities identified on the IRP.
- *Child Care Services*: TANF families are eligible for the Idaho Child Care Program (ICCP) if child care is needed for a parent or caretaker relative to participate in Individual Responsibility Plan activities. When a parent becomes employed and terminates TANF, the family may continue to receive child care as a Work-Related Service if they continue to meet ICCP eligibility requirements.

O. Child Support Services

Cooperation with Child Support Services is a requirement of TANF eligibility unless good cause exists. Cooperation with Child Support is critical because it supports and encourages parental responsibility through the activities of child support collection. The process of cooperation is discussed with each TANF applicant. A TANF applicant must cooperate in identifying the non-custodial parent, locating that parent, and establishing a support order as a condition of receiving TANF. If paternity has not been established, the applicant must cooperate with identifying and locating the father. Once TANF eligibility is established, the participant must continue to cooperate with child support requirements.

Idaho's TANF and Child Support services are linked into the Department's overall Self-Reliance program. An applicant is screened to assess whether child support is being paid and, if not, the reasons for non-payment. Child support screening is necessary for the Department to ascertain which services are most appropriate to meet the family's needs. Child Support services are key to participants achieving self-reliance. The processes to gather information, identify, locate, and enforce support orders begin at the time of application for assistance. Upon completion of the assessment, enforcement action takes place.

This is accomplished through an interface between the eligibility system and the child support enforcement system.

P. Head Start

The Head Start Program provides child development services to children. The target population is families who are TANF eligible or at risk of becoming eligible, and whose income does not exceed 200% of the Federal Poverty Guideline. The program includes a developmentally appropriate individualized curriculum, socialization and health screening, as well as immunizations and medical, dental, nutrition, and mental health services. While TANF funds are not used to provide medical, dental, and immunization services, the Head Start programs do provide these services for TANF eligible children with Head Start funds or other non-TANF sources.

Q. Work-Related Activities

The definition of “needy” is applicable to TANF-eligible families with a dependent child residing in their home. The State delivers consistent work-related activities statewide through the Employment and Training program maintained by a contractor. Participants in work-related activities must complete and fulfill a IRP. Adults are expected to participate immediately in work-related activities, including job search. A single custodial parent caring for a child twelve (12) weeks of age or less during a month will not be required to engage in work activities as defined in PRWORA 407(d). While this parent may be disregarded in determining participation rates for only 12 weeks, a single custodial parent is expected to complete a IRP and participate in activities that will help them become self-sufficient. Families are expected to accept employment as soon as it is available to them. Families who gain employment will be given needed assistance to learn how to use community resources and support in maintaining that employment after they leave the program. A working family that continues to be eligible for TANF will receive continued support from the Department to improve their self-reliance capabilities. These activity hours are monitored by the Contractor and provided to the Department to determine that State’s work participation rate to ensure compliance with 407(a)(1). See the following pages for a chart of work-related activities.

<i>DESCRIPTION OF WORK-RELATED ACTIVITIES</i>	
Unsubsidized Employment	Individual receiving wages from public, private, or self-employment
Subsidized Private Sector Employment	Individual in private sector employment for which the employer receives a subsidy from TANF or other public funds to offset some or all the wages and costs of employing a recipient.
Subsidized Public Sector Employment	Individual in public sector employment receiving subsidized wages from another program for training provided to offset some or all of the wages and costs of employing a recipient.
On the Job Training	On the Job Training (OJT) means training in the public or private sector given to a paid employee while he is engaged in productive work and provides knowledge and skills essential to the full and adequate performance on the job. Theoretically, WIOA funding supports OJT activities in Idaho.
Work Opportunities	Individual in unpaid short-term pre-employment work experience (workfare) based on a signed Memorandum of Agreement between the

	Department and the work site. Also includes an individual placed in work experience (not community service) by another agency's program, such as Vocational Rehabilitation or Probation and Parole. The purpose of the work experience is to improve the employability of those who cannot find unsubsidized employment.
Community Service	Individual who performs volunteer work for the direct benefit of community organizations (public or nonprofit) or has been assigned Community Service by a court.
Work Finding Activities	Individual who is involved in active job search or participating in work preparation activities (job readiness). These activities may include job readiness assessment, classes, workshops, or one-on-one training on resume writing, how to interview, how to keep a job, budgeting, setting up a business, etc.
Education	Education directly related to employment in the case of a recipient who has not received a high school diploma or a certificate of high school equivalency, would be education related to a specific job, occupation or job offer.
Employment Preparation Education (Job Skills Training)	Job skills training directly related to employment is training or education for job skills required by an employer to provide an individual with the ability to obtain employment or to advance or adapt to the changing demands of the workplace.
Vocational Training	Training (not to exceed 12 months with respect to any individual) is organized educational programs that are directly related to the preparation of individuals for employment in current or emerging occupations requiring training other than a baccalaureate or advanced degree.
Other Activities	Individual involved in activities designed to improve the ability to obtain and maintain employment, which may include life skills training, non-work-related assessment, following doctor's instructions, using community resources such as diabetes centers, alcohol and drug rehabilitation, physical therapy, etc. These activities can be counted for non-CORE activities hours but do not count toward CORE hours for the work participation rate. In addition, TANF funds are not used to pay for medical services.

R. Child Care Services for Non-TANF Families

Working Idaho families with a dependent child are eligible for Child Care Services when they meet current ICCP eligibility guidelines. Child Care Services expenses for non-TANF families may be paid by direct TANF funds for working families who qualify for ICCP. Payment for Child Care Services is made directly to the providers.

S. Contracts for Employment and Training and Case Management

Employment and Training (E&T) serves individuals who are unable to meet the basic needs of their family or the children they support. For the purposes of E&T, the term "needy" includes families whose income is no greater than 200% of FPG, non-custodial parents whose income is no greater than 400% of FPG, and families who are eligible for Food Stamps, Medicaid, and ICCP. The services are funded by

TANF and State MOE funds. E&T is a comprehensive set of services that assist participants in finding employment, maintaining employment, or improving their employment situation. The E&T contractor provides individualized services essential to a participant's entry into employment. Activities depend upon the applicant's circumstances and require up to 40 hours per week in work-related activities, described under Work Related Activities on pages 9-10. Additionally, some adults may be served who are at risk of losing their ability to support their family or children they support. E&T helps end dependence of needy parents on government benefits by promoting job preparation and work.

T. Case Management of Child-Only Ineligible Alien (IA) Cases

Case management for child-only cases involving Ineligible Aliens (IA) is carried out solely by a contracted service provider. No TANF cash assistance or other federally funded services are provided to IA cases, consistent with 8 U.S.C. § 1611 and the 2024 HHS PRWORA notice clarifying federal public benefit restrictions.

Once the family is determined eligible for TANF, the case is referred to the contractor for ongoing case management. The contractor is responsible for Individual Responsibility Plan (IRP) development and management, timesheet submission, and activity hour tracking and keying for IA cases. These activities are administrative and supportive only; no TANF payments or federal public benefits are provided to IA individuals.

U. Transitional Services

Transitional Services may be provided to an individual whose family is no longer eligible for TANF cash assistance due to employment or who requested TANF closure because of employment. At the time of closure, the family's income must be below 200% of FPG. The family must have received TANF for at least one partial month or one full month within the past 12 months and have a need for work-related services in order to maintain employment. This assistance includes paying directly to vendors on behalf of the individual on Transitional Services work-related expenses including clothing, tools, transportation costs, licensure, and certification fees. Transitional Services may be provided for up to 12 months after TANF ends due to employment and do not count toward the TANF 24-month time limit. Services are supported by federal TANF funds.

V. Supportive Services

Supportive Services are for participants who are receiving TANF or are on Food Stamps and have completed a CE plan. Supportive Services are paid directly to vendors, and include work-related expenses such as transportation costs, clothing, necessary tools and equipment, licensure, and certification fees. Expenditures for Supportive Services may not be paid for child care, medical services, purchase of vehicles, housing and utility costs, services for children, credit card accounts, household items, fines, professional union or trade dues, or any services available through another resource, as these expenses do not fall under the Supportive Services category. Child Care Services are available through the Idaho Child Care Program and are funded either through CCDF or direct TANF funds. Supportive Services are supported by TANF and State MOE funds, and may be provided to adult participants who receive:

- *TANF Cash Assistance*: Supportive services must be needed to support an element of the Individual Responsibility Plan (IRP).

- *Extended Cash Assistance*
- *Transitional Services*: Supportive services must be directly related to maintaining employment and may include mentoring, counseling, and training for up to 12 months.
- *Career Enhancement Services*: Supportive services help individuals maintain or obtain employment. Career Enhancement supportive services must not extend beyond four (4) months per episode of need, and the individual may only receive one (1) Career Enhancement payment in a twelve (12) month period.

W. Supportive Services for Refugees

Supportive Services payments are payments made to help families obtain, maintain, or enhance employment. Refugee families with children who are receiving services under the federal Office of Refugee Resettlement (ORR) funding may receive Supportive Services payments. In addition, refugee families who are no longer receiving ORR funded services may also receive Supportive Services payments if they are at or below 200% of Federal Poverty Guidelines or are receiving Food Stamps, Medicaid or ICCP benefits. Supportive Services payments are made directly to vendors and may include work-related expenses such as transportation costs, clothing, necessary tools and equipment, licensure, and certification fees. Expenditures for Supportive Services may not be paid for child care, medical services, purchase of vehicles, housing and utility costs, services for children, credit card accounts, household items, fines, professional union or trade dues, or any services available through another resource, as these expenses do not fall under the Supportive Services category.

X. Receipting Services Only

TANF funds are used for child support receipting only services not allowed through the IV-D Program to accomplish TANF Purpose 4. These are cases where an order has already been established through family court not involving the department requiring a non-custodial parent to pay child support to the custodial parent. The department will provide for the family receipting of these payments only but will not enforce the order that was put into place, unless the department was involved in the establishment of the original child support order. Cases where the support order is on or after January 1, 1994, and the payment is made by wage withholding are eligible for funding by the Child Support Enforcement program. Older cases or cases where payment is not made by wage withholding an allocable portion may be charged to TANF.

Y. Subsidized Employment Services

The Division of Welfare began a subsidized employment program on February 1, 2010. This program creates employment for unemployed or under employed (i.e., under 200% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines) TANF-eligible Idahoans while supporting the current Welfare workforce and the unprecedented caseload increase in the Food Stamp program. Subsidized employment is a countable work activity in which a recipient's cash assistance is diverted to an employer as an incentive for the employer to hire and train a TANF recipient for a position that can lead to full-time unsubsidized employment.

A subsidized employment placement is intended to:

- Provide a meaningful, paid work experience that will improve the participant's long-term employability.

- Encourage an employer to provide a job opportunity to an individual whose work history may be deficient but who appears to be job ready.
- Provide monetary compensation to an employer for providing the recipient with an opportunity to work.

Placement is defined as the date on which the client enters subsidized employment.

Z. Family and Community Services (FACS) Programs

i. Emergency Assistance Authorized by TANF

Emergency Assistance is designed to assist families with an eligible child who are experiencing specific emergency conditions. A family may be eligible for Emergency Assistance if their income is below 200% of the current federal poverty guideline or they are unable to meet the emergency condition because of circumstances beyond their control. Funded through federal TANF funds, Emergency Assistance benefits are non-recurrent, short-term payments for goods and services relating to specific emergency conditions.

A family has an emergency condition when:

- A child is in a vulnerable situation that indicates an emergency condition exists, including insufficient resources immediately available to meet his basic needs, and the unmet needs may be a threat to the child's health, safety, stability, or well-being that place the child at risk of destitution.

Payment is limited to the least amount necessary to get the family through the emergency and is always paid directly to a third party, such as a utility company. The family may receive Emergency Assistance for up to 120 consecutive days in a twelve-month period from the date of application.

Payments are linked to service plans developed by the family to ensure the safety and well-being of children and the stability of the family. Emergency Assistance payments, partnered with the family's service plan, help participating families in need maintain stability so that their children may be cared for in their own homes or in the homes of relatives. An individual who is required to participate in a work program must not have refused, without good cause, to accept employment or training for employment in order to be eligible for Emergency Assistance funding. It will be the responsibility of the Emergency Assistance case worker and the family to collaborate with other programs to cure any TANF sanction prior to a potential distribution of Emergency Assistance funds being considered.

The child must have lived with one (1) or both parents or an adult relative, within six (6) months prior to the month of application for emergency assistance. A child may move from one (1) household to another and be eligible to receive emergency assistance in either household.

When children are in the custody of the state, the residency requirement does not need to be met if an Emergency Assistance-related need is the last barrier to the child being reunified with their family.

AA. Out-of-Wedlock Pregnancy Prevention

i. Marketing

The Idaho Family Planning Program (IFPP) plans to run public service announcements (PSAs) on positive parent-child communication and to encourage young adults ages 18-24 to make a plans to avoid unintended pregnancy to protect their health and reach their goals. The IFPP will provide resources to parents/caregivers and young adults to reduce unintended pregnancy and STD/HIV infections. These resources will be provided digitally on the IFPP website.

ii. Programming Resources

Curriculum: Families Talking Together

The IFPP will support parent-child communication by providing education using the Families Talking Together (FTT) curriculum. FTT is a parent engagement curriculum that provides parents with the tools and strategies to improve communication with their adolescent children, especially as it relates to sexual health. FTT is a parent-based intervention facilitated by trained health educators to prevent and/or reduce sexual risk behavior among adolescents. The program can be in the form of a one-on-one training to parents, or in small group settings. The primary component of the FTT intervention is a written program manual, distributed to parents, which is designed to promote effective communication skills, build parent-adolescent relationships, help parents develop successful monitoring strategies, and teach adolescents assertiveness and refusal skills. Participation in FTT sessions help parents gain the confidence they need to establish strong communication and to maintain open lines of communication with their adolescents as they progress toward adulthood.

BB. Domestic Violence

For purposes of this paragraph the term “domestic violence” has the same meaning as the term “battered or subjected to extreme cruelty”, as defined in section 408(a)(7)(c)(iii) of the Act. The Department has established and is enforcing standards and procedures to screen and identify TANF participants with a history of domestic violence while protecting their privacy. Services include referral of such individuals to counseling and supportive services. The Department disregards, pursuant to good cause, certain program requirements, such as:

- Time limits (for so long as necessary) for individuals receiving assistance.
- Residency requirements.
- Family cap provisions.
- Where compliance with such requirements would make it more difficult for individuals receiving assistance to escape domestic violence or would unfairly penalize such individuals who are or have been victimized by such violence or are at risk of further domestic violence.

The Department will identify and provide additional, targeted support to victims of domestic violence who may have particular difficulty successfully making the transition from welfare to work. Training is provided to Department staff to help them understand the issues surrounding domestic violence. Community resources, including agencies whose mission is working with domestic violence victims, have been identified. Activities required on the PRC are structured to accommodate the specific situation of a participant. Although the Department expects that participants immediately focus on employment, the PRC will be appropriate to the participant’s situation. Assessment of each situation is based on the

participant's capabilities and strengths. Department staff employs a "reasonable person" standard when evaluating appropriateness of activities.

CC. Training Related to Occupations in Elder Care

The State does not intend to provide targeted assistance to individuals to train for, seek, and maintain employment providing direct care in a long-term care facility or other occupations related to elder care at this time. Training in this field will be made available on an individual basis.

3. MAINTENANCE OF EFFORT (MOE) FUNDED SERVICES

The Department funds Family Preservation Services, Employment and Training, Cash Assistance, Eligibility and Administrative Support, and Tribal TANF services with State General funds in order to meet the Maintenance of Effort requirement.

A. Family Preservation Services

i. Prevention Services

Prevention Services are provided to families when a safety assessment determines that a child is unsafe but can remain at home with an active safety plan in place. Services include:

- Conducting comprehensive assessments to evaluate family safety, risk factors, and strengths.
- Collaboratively developing case plan goals with the family.
- Completing regular home visits to ensure child safety and track progress toward case plan goals.
- Coordinating services and working with providers to support and monitor family progress.

These activities are delivered through Family and Community Services Programs to help prevent the need for children's placement in foster care.

B. Employment and Training

State General funds are used in conjunction with TANF funds to pay for job readiness, job placement, subsidized employment, and case management conducted on behalf of families (at or below 200% of poverty) who are receiving TANF or Food Stamps. These activities support purpose 1 and 2:

- Assisting needy families so that children can be cared for in their own homes.
- Reducing the dependency of needy parents by promoting job preparation, work, and marriage.

C. Cash Assistance

State General funds are used in conjunction with TANF funds to pay cash assistance to needy families participating in the Temporary Assistance for Families in Idaho (TANF). Refer to page 3 for eligibility criteria. These activities support purpose 1 and 2:

- Assisting needy families so that children can be cared for in their own homes.
- Reducing the dependency of needy parents by promoting job preparation, work, and marriage.

D. Eligibility and Administrative Support

State General funds are used in conjunction with TANF funds to administer all TANF services. This includes determining initial and ongoing eligibility for families served with these funds.

E. Tribal TANF Programs

Each of the Coeur d'Alene, Nez Perce, and Shoshone-Bannock Tribes receive State General MOE funds based on their share of the annual family assistance program established on December 22, 1999. These funds are used to provide basic cash assistance to Tribal members (at or below 200% of poverty) participating in their Tribal TANF programs.

The Coeur d'Alene, Nez Perce, and Shoshone-Bannock Tribes are currently operating their own programs. Idaho provides equitable access to assistance through the state program for each member of an Indian tribe living in the state and not eligible for assistance through a tribal family assistance plan. Department staff attends quarterly meetings with the tribes to discuss TANF issues. A federal liaison also attends these meetings. In accordance with 42 U.S.C. 608 (a)(7)(d)(i) and (ii), the State will disregard any month during which an adult TANF participant lived in Indian country if the most reliable data available with respect to the month or period including the month indicate that at least 50 percent of the adults living in Indian country were not employed.

4. COORDINATION OF SERVICES

Across the state, many public and private programs work for the well-being of children and families. These community programs offer a wide range of services that focus on parenting skills and responsibilities. The Department provides services to many of the same families served by these community programs. The Department collaborates with community services programs to promote parental responsibility, bringing all the programs to the same table to share critical information, focus on common needs, and reduce repetitive actions.

5. FRAUD AND ABUSE

The Department uses an integrated eligibility system for which at the time of initial application, information is verified through documentation provided as well as interfaces built into the system that include the Department of Labor, Social Security, and the Work Number. Anytime a change occurs, the system can be checked in real time, to mitigate fraud and or intentional program violations. The Department has an Integrity Unit which receives referrals regarding customers who may have received benefits they were not entitled to. For cases that need additional investigation, they are referred to a Fraud Investigator to investigate further and if meet a prosecution standard are forwarded to a state prosecutor. The TANF program incorporates family penalties into the program rules and when a participant does not report a change in income, resources, or household composition, without good cause, the family is ineligible for a period of one month for the first occurrence and three months for any additional occurrences. Deliberate failure to report a change may be pursued as an Intentional Program Violation (IPV), which is a full family sanction. The first violation results in a 12-month ineligibility period, a second violation results in a 24-month ineligibility period and the third violation results in permanent disqualification from the TANF program. All IPV's and their disqualification periods previously acquired through Families with Dependent Children (AFDC) are counted toward the Idaho TANF program. The disqualified individual's needs are not included in the grant calculation, and the individual's income and resources count towards the family's eligibility calculation.

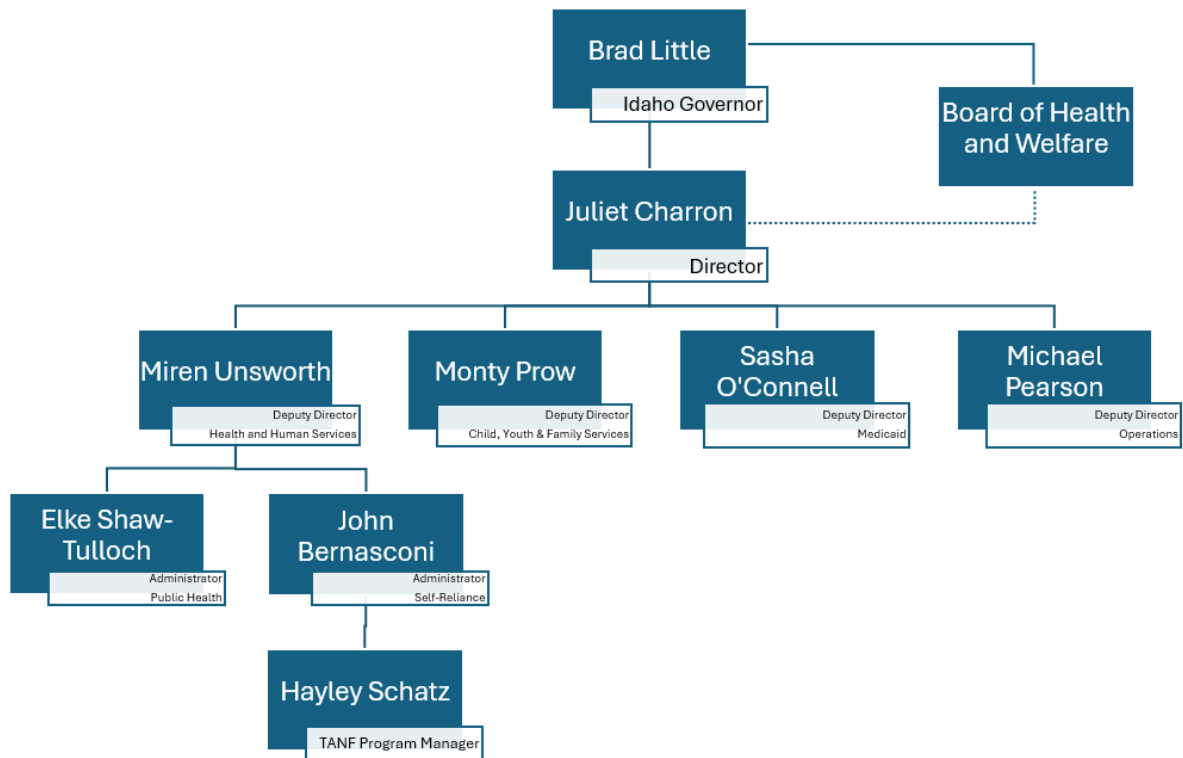
6. PLAN AMENDMENTS

Within 30 days after adopting new procedures, the state will submit a plan amendment and notify the secretary of the amendment.

7. PUBLIC AVAILABILITY OF STATE PLAN SUMMARY

The State of Idaho shall make available to the public a summary of any plan or plan amendment section.

APPENDIX A: ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE



ATTACHMENT A: STATE PLAN CERTIFICATIONS

The State of Idaho operates the Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) program so that children may be cared for in their own homes or in the homes of relatives; to end dependence of needy parents on government benefits by promoting job preparation, work, and marriage; to prevent and reduce the incidence of out-of-wedlock pregnancies and establish annual numerical goals for preventing and reducing the incidence of these pregnancies; and to encourage the formation and maintenance of two-parent families.

This program is known as Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF).

The Executive Officer of the State is Brad Little, Governor.

In administering and operating a program that provides Temporary Assistance for Needy Families with minor children under title IV-A of the Social Security Act,

1a. I certify that the Idaho Department of Health and Welfare is the agency responsible for administering the program, and the Idaho Department of Health and Welfare is the agency responsible for supervising the program.

1b. I assure that local governments and private sector organizations:

(I) have been consulted regarding the plan and design of welfare services in the State so that services are provided in a manner appropriate to local populations; and

(II) have had at least 45 days to submit comments on the plan and the design of such services.

2. During the fiscal year, the State will operate a Child Support Enforcement program under the State plan approved under part D.

3. During the fiscal year, the Department of Health and Welfare operates a Foster Care and Adoption Assistance program in accordance with part E and takes all necessary actions to ensure that children receiving assistance are eligible for medical assistance under the State plan under title XIX.

4. The State will provide each member of an Indian tribe, who is domiciled in the State and is not eligible for assistance under a Tribal Family Assistance plan approved under Section 412, with equitable access to assistance under the State program funded under this part attributable to funds provided by the Federal Government.

5. The State has established and is enforcing standards and procedures to ensure against program fraud and abuse, including standards and procedures concerning nepotism, conflicts of interest among individuals responsible for the administration and supervision of the State program, kickbacks, and the use of political patronage.

ATTACHMENT B: DOMESTIC VIOLENCE CERTIFICATION

I also certify the State has established and is enforcing standards and procedures to:

- Ensure that applicants and potential applicants for assistance under the state program funded under this part are notified of assistance made available by the state to victims of sexual harassment and survivors of domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking.
- Ensure that case workers and other agency personnel responsible for administering the state program funded under this part are trained in:
 - The nature and dynamics of sexual harassment and domestic violence, sexual assault, and stalking;
 - State standards and procedures relating to the prevention of, and assistance for, individuals who are victims of sexual harassment or survivors of domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking; and
 - Methods of ascertaining and ensuring the confidentiality of personal information and documentation related to applicants for assistance and their children who have provided notice about their experiences of sexual harassment, domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking.
- Screen and identify individuals receiving assistance under this part with a history of domestic violence, sexual assault or stalking while maintaining the confidentiality of such individuals.
- Refer such individuals to counseling and supportive services; and
- Waive, pursuant to a determination of good cause, other program requirements such as time limits (for as long as necessary) for individuals receiving assistance, residency requirements, child support cooperation requirements, and family cap provisions, in cases where compliance with such requirements would make it more difficult for individuals receiving assistance under this part to escape domestic violence or would unfairly penalize such individuals who are or have been victimized by such violence, or individuals who are at risk of further domestic violence.

CERTIFIED BY THE CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER OF THE STATE:

Brad Little
Idaho Governor

Date

ATTACHMENT C: FUNDING

Section 403(a)(1)(A) provides that each eligible State shall be entitled to receive for each fiscal year, a grant in an amount equal to the State family assistance grant as defined in section 403(a)(1)(B).

I. Payments to Agency Administering the TANF Program

Payments for the TANF program will be made to the organization managing the TANF programs as of August 22, 1996, unless the State indicates that the TANF administering agency is changed. If a change is made, describe the name, address and EIN number of the new organization.

II. State Payments for TANF Program

Section 405 requires that grants be paid to States in quarterly installments, based on State estimates. The State's estimate for each quarter of the fiscal year by percentage is:

For FY 2026 and Future Years			
1st Quarter	2nd Quarter	3rd Quarter	4th Quarter
25% or \$7,576,791	25% or \$7,576,791	25% or \$7,576,791	25% or \$7,576,791

For FY 2020, States should indicate below the percentage of TANF funds requested for only those quarters in which they plan to operate the program.

For FY 2026			
1st Quarter	2nd Quarter	3rd Quarter	4th Quarter
25% or \$7,576,791	25% or \$7,576,791	25% or \$7,576,791	25% or \$7,576,791

III. Changes and Inquiries

If a State determines that these estimates require changes, a letter indicating the change in percentages should be sent to your ACF Regional Office and to ACF's Central Office.